

Finding an Apartment

If you're looking in your own town, you probably know about some of the apartment complexes in your area. It's more difficult if you're moving to a new city, especially if you don't have the luxury of being able to go there to find housing before you move. A number of methods can make it easier.

Word of Mouth and Classified Ads

If you know people in the neighborhood you're considering, ask them for recommendations. You'll learn important information that might not be readily apparent when you walk through the building, such as noise levels, and the safety of the neighborhood. The local newspapers in most towns and cities advertise apartments for rent. You might even grab independent newspapers that you find in coffee shops and pizza joints for a wider variety of inexpensive places. On the Internet, try www.craigslist.org or special sections of local papers' websites that have listings not found in the hard-copy editions.

Using a Real Estate Agent

The benefit of using real estate agents is that they're familiar with where the apartment complexes are and with the neighborhoods they're in. The easiest way to find realtors with rentals is by searching the Internet. Go to a good search engine and type in "real estate agents" or "realtors" and the name of the city and state. While you're searching, keep an eye out for agents who offer relocation packages with information about the city you're going to be living in. This could be helpful once you move.

Apartment-Finder Services

Apartment finders or locators are companies that specialize in knowing all the apartment complexes in a given area. They work with apartment property managers to keep up-to-date on apartment availability, and save